

Charge Certificate Automation

Final Developer Workflow + AI Intelligence Specification

Purpose: Keep the customer-facing journey extremely small while making the AI analysis precise, controlled and document-led. The AI must not simply be told to 'analyse the Charge Certificate'. It must be given an explicit job, required fields, decision rules and safeguards.

1. Customer Journey

Upload front and back -> choose A or B -> short explanation / optional evidence -> customer details -> pay £4.99 -> generate and download.

The customer should not need to understand the legislation or identify the type of enforcement regime. That work happens behind the scenes.

2. Upload & Document Validation

The customer must upload the **front and back** of the Charge Certificate. The AI first determines whether the uploaded document is actually a Charge Certificate.

If it is not a Charge Certificate, stop the workflow and direct the customer to the appropriate service. If the document is unreadable or essential information cannot be identified reliably, the system should ask for a clearer/full upload rather than guessing.

3. What the AI Must Extract

The developer should explicitly instruct the AI to look for and return, where available:

- **Document type** - confirm Charge Certificate.
- **Issuing authority**.
- **PCN/reference number**.
- **Vehicle registration**.
- **Charge Certificate date**.
- **Amount outstanding**.
- **Contravention description/code**, where shown.
- **Contravention category** - e.g. parking, moving traffic, bus lane or other supported council enforcement.
- **Underlying notice type** - e.g. PCN / Notice to Owner, where identifiable.
- **All relevant dates** appearing on the document.
- **Applicable enforcement regime**, where it can be reliably determined from the authority, notice wording and contravention.
- **Progression stage** - identify anything showing that the case has moved beyond Charge Certificate stage.

4. AI Confidence / No-Guess Rule

The AI must distinguish between information it can establish from the document and information it cannot establish. Missing or uncertain information must not be invented.

Developer rule: if a legal conclusion depends on a fact or enforcement regime the AI cannot identify reliably, it must omit that legal assertion or request the minimum additional information/document required. It must never fill gaps by assumption.

5. Main Customer Question

Why are you challenging the Charge Certificate?

A - Non-receipt	B - Representations / appeal
I did not receive the original PCN / Notice to Owner.	I appealed / made representations but did not receive a response.

6. Option A - Non-receipt

Ask: **Why do you think you did not receive it?** Use one free-text box. Helper examples: away from home, moved address, postal/non-delivery issue, or only became aware when the Charge Certificate arrived.

Then offer an **optional evidence upload**. The AI reads the explanation and evidence and extracts useful facts such as travel dates, address-change dates or other relevant circumstances.

Being away is **not** a separate workflow or PDF. It is a factual variation within the non-receipt template.

7. Option B - Representations Made / No Response

Ask: **Approximately when did you submit your appeal or representations?** Exact date is not mandatory. Then offer an optional evidence upload for acknowledgements, emails, screenshots, copies of representations or other proof.

The AI should analyse the uploaded material to establish, where possible:

- what was challenged and which PCN it relates to;
- whether the material appears to be an informal challenge or formal representations;
- the date submitted or acknowledged;
- whether a response/decision is evidenced;
- the applicable enforcement regime and any legally relevant response period.

8. Legal Deadline Selection - AI Must Decide Before Writing

The system must **not automatically insert '56 days'** simply because the customer says they appealed. Different notice types and enforcement regimes may require different treatment.

The AI must first classify the case from the Charge Certificate and supporting material, then select only the legal module that applies. If a 56-day statutory period applies and the dates show it has expired, the generated PDF may use that argument. If another regime/rule applies, use the correct wording. If the position cannot be established reliably, do not invent a deadline.

Where appropriate, the generated wording may also refer to the relevant statutory guidance, but only after the applicable regime has been identified.

9. Two Core Generated PDF Templates

Template A - Non-receipt: Personalised factual explanation of why the original PCN / Notice to Owner was not received, incorporating relevant evidence. Request that the authority exercise discretion and restore/revert the case to the appropriate earlier stage.

Template B - Representations/no response: Personalised account of the representations, relevant dates/evidence, lack of response and the correct procedural/legal wording selected from the applicable enforcement regime.

There are only **two core templates**. Circumstances and legal paragraphs are modular, so the AI personalises the correct template rather than creating dozens of separate PDFs.

10. Customer Details & Payment

Collect only **full name, address and email**, unless another detail is genuinely required and cannot be obtained from the documents.

Price: **£4.99**. CTA: **Pay £4.99 & Generate My Challenge**.

11. Hard Rules for the AI

- Never invent facts, dates, evidence, statutory provisions or response periods.
- Never ask the customer to type information already reliably extracted from the documents.
- Never assume that an appeal was a formal representation merely because the customer calls it an appeal.
- Never automatically use the 56-day argument.
- Never tell the customer that a Charge Certificate is automatically invalid.
- Never present this product as a statutory appeal against the Charge Certificate.
- Never generate TE7/TE9 or PE2/PE3 within this product.
- If the matter is already at Order for Recovery stage, stop and direct the customer to the separate £30 Order for Recovery service.
- Use the customer's evidence only for facts it actually supports.
- If essential information is unclear, request the smallest possible clarification rather than creating a long questionnaire.

12. Implementation Approach - No Fine-tuning Required Initially

The initial version does **not** need a separately trained/fine-tuned AI model. The developer should use a capable document/vision model with a detailed system instruction, structured extraction fields, legal decision rules and the hard safeguards above.

The model's output should ideally be structured internally (for example: document_type, authority, PCN, vehicle, dates, contravention_category, notice_type, enforcement_regime, customer_route, evidence_facts, applicable_legal_module, confidence/uncertainty). The customer does not need to see these technical fields.

13. Testing Before Launch

Before launch, test the workflow against a representative set of real Charge Certificates from different councils and enforcement types. Testing should check document recognition, extraction accuracy, classification, non-receipt evidence handling, formal/informal representation distinction, legal-module selection and the stop rule for later-stage documents.

Any repeated error should be corrected in the AI instructions/rules and retested. The goal is controlled behaviour, not reliance on the model's general knowledge alone.

Developer Summary

The AI already has general document/legal language capability, but this product must explicitly tell it what to identify, what decisions it is permitted to make, what legal wording can be selected, and what it must never assume. Customer simplicity is achieved by putting this complexity behind the scenes.